ZEITGEIST
MOONLIT REVELRY



HIDDEN ELEMENT

Rulebook 2026

INTRODUCTION

Hidden Element challenges participants to notice and creatively incorporate an assigned object into a photograph.

The object may be the main subject or a subtle detail within the frame. The goal is to make it feel naturally connected to the image.

TASK

Each participant will be assigned a random object.

Capture one photograph in which the assigned object is naturally integrated into the scene. Object will be assigned on Day 1 of Zeitgei

Along with the photograph, submit a short explanation of the frame and the idea or story behind it.

REGISTRATION RULES

- This is an online individual event under Zeitgeist'26.
- Students from all institutions are eligible to participate.
- Only one entry per participant is allowed

GUIDELINES

FORMAT

- Each participant will receive one assigned object from the organizers on Day 1 of Zeitgeist.
- The assigned object must be physically present in the photograph and should be recognizable, even if it is not the main subject.
- The object may be the central focus or a subtle part of the composition, but it must be intentionally incorporated into the frame.
- The photograph must be captured by the participant during the event timeline.
- One photograph and one short explanation may be submitted per participant.

EDITING RULES

- Only global adjustments are permitted, such as exposure correction, contrast, highlights, shadows, white balance, color tuning, sharpness, noise reduction, cropping and straightening.
- Selective or local edits (masking, brushing, subject or background edits, gradient filters, etc.) are not allowed
- Compositing, background replacement, object removal or addition, sky replacement and AI-generated edits are strictly prohibited
- The scene, objects and composition must remain unchanged from the original capture.

AUTHENTICITY RULES

- The final edited image must be created strictly from the submitted RAW file.
- Image metadata (EXIF) must remain intact.
- Use of stock images, previously captured photographs or third-party content is not permitted
- Any inconsistency between the RAW file and the edited image will lead to disqualification.

SUBMISSION RULES

Each participant must submit:

- One RAW file
- One edited image

File naming format:

- ParticipantName_HiddenElement_RAW
- ParticipantName_HiddenElement_EDITED

Design Specifications: Aspect ratio - Open

Colour scheme: Free choice

File format: RAW in original camera format (DNG / NEF / ARW / CR2, etc.), final image in JPEG or PNG format

- A fixed submission window will be announced for the event.
- Participants may use any camera device (mobile phones, DSLR or mirrorless cameras).

- Entries must be submitted online before the specified deadline.
- Participants may share their final photograph on social media after submission using the official event hashtag.

JUDGING CRITERIA

- Creative use and integration of the assigned object.
- Originality of the concept and visual storytelling.
- Composition, framing, and lighting.
- How naturally the object fits into the photograph.
- Overall visual impact and adherence to the rules.

PRIZES WORTH 4K

- Winner - 2000
- First Runner Up - 1000
- Second Runner Up - 750

Participation certificates will be provided to all participants with valid submissions.

PARTICIPATION FEES:

Entry fees: ₹90

CONTACTS

For any queries, feel free to contact:

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NOTE

- Any changes or updates regarding the event will be announced before the submission deadline.
- Any form of rule violation, unfair practices, plagiarism, excessive editing or RAW mismatch will result in immediate disqualification.
- The decision of the organizing committee shall be final and binding.

End